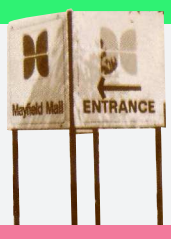
MOUNTAIN REVIEW
OFFICIAL NEWSLETTER OF THE MOUNTAIN VIEW HISTORICAL ASSOCIATION
Volume VI Issue II Spring 2016

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MVHA SPRING 2016 EVENT

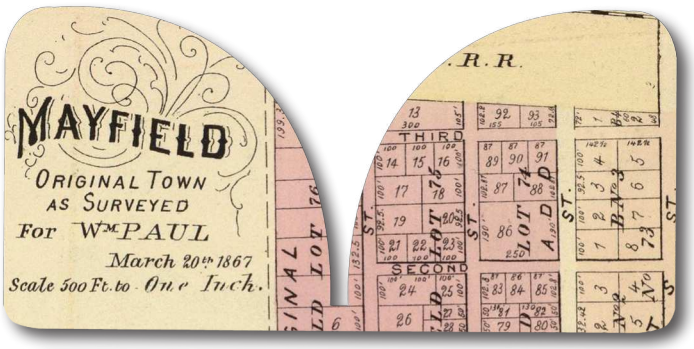
More than a mall: Mayfield!

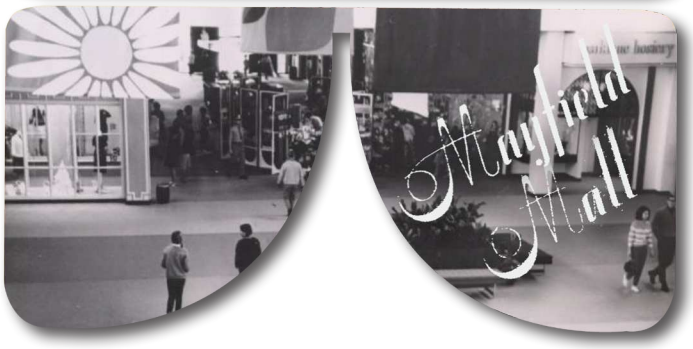
Mark your calendars for the Mountain View Historical Association's Spring Event and Membership Meeting, "More Than a Mall: Mayfield!"

Fifty years ago Mayfield Mall, one of the first indoor shopping malls in the Bay Area, opened in Mountain View. Many fondly remember the mall, but fewer know the history behind the mall's name or are aware of the Town of Mayfield, one of the oldest settlements in the Santa Clara Valley and Mountain View's former neighbor to the north.

Join us on May 1 at Mountain View's historic Adobe Building as Palo Alto historian **Steve Staiger** shares the tale of the long-lost Town of Mayfield, and Mountain View history book author **Nick Perry** presents a slide show on Mayfield Mall. Fascinating local history, tasty refreshments, pleasant company, in a beautiful historic landmark—a great way to celebrate May Day!

We hope to see you there!





EVENT DETAILS

When: Sunday, May 1, 2016, from 1:00 to 3:00 p.m.
Where: The Adobe Building, 157 Moffett Blvd. Mountain View, CA
Cost: This event is free and open to the public! Non-members are kindly asked to RSVP at **http://mvhistory.eventbrite.com** to help us manage seating arrangements.

MOUNTAIN REVIEW

This newsletter is published four times a year by the
MOUNTAIN VIEW HISTORICAL ASSOCIATION
P.O. Box 252, Mountain View, CA 94042
www.mountainviewhistorical.org

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Publicity: Marina Marinovich

In Memoriam

Louis A. Beck
Febuary 24, 2014

Jay Thomas Dickson
May 22, 1924–December 22, 2015

Allen Gurley Schaumburg
November 16, 2015

News & Notes

President's Message

By Candace Bowers
MVHA President

Since you are probably wondering why my name appears in this byline instead of that of Pat Figueroa, I will tell you with mixed feelings that I have taken on Pat's role as president of our association, as Pat needs to end her term early, rather than at the end of the year. While I am happy to step into this position, I will certainly miss Pat and her dedication to all things Mountain View. The Board and I are so grateful to her for all she has done for the Association and for our city.

You might know me from the library and/or the Mountain View History Center. I've been with the library for 26 years, first as the bookmobile driver and now as a librarian in the adult services department. I also staff the History Center on Tuesdays. Having driven the bookmobile through the neighborhoods of Mountain View for four years, I often feel that there's not a single street name I don't know. I am occasionally proven wrong, though, by a visitor to the History Center who stumps me with a question—I am constantly learning something new from our residents.

I'm also hoping to meet more of you at our Spring Event on May 1, where we'll host a program about Mayfield, the town AND the mall. We'll be welcoming Steve Staiger from the Palo Alto Historical Association, as well as our own Nick Perry. August brings our famous summer BBQ, featuring those beloved Parisian burgers. For our fall event, we're planning a celebration of Mountain View's Mexican-American heritage. You can also spot us at the annual downtown parade on Saturday, April 23, (appropriately) in one of our board member's vintage automobiles.

Finally, I would like to share the good news that the Friends of the Immigrant House has indeed received the much-needed funding for the Immigrant House restoration project, from the County's Historical Heritage Commission, in response to their grant request. The house's future location at 771. N. Rengstorff Ave. will offer the community a new city park with a historic connection—a win/win for all!

See you at the Adobe!—Candace

Financial Report

By John Figueroa
Treasurer

Checking Account Balance as of 1/6/16: $12,816.36
- Income: $6.35
- Expenses: $328.19

Checking Account Balance as of 3/9/16: $12,494.52

Certificates of Deposit Balance as of 1/6/16: $71,806.01
Certificates of Deposit Balance as of 3/9/16: $71,867.07

Immigrant House Update!

Editor's Note: *Publicity Chair Marina Marinovich wanted us to share the exciting news that the Immigrant House has received a $50,000 grant from the Santa Clara County Board of Supervisors. Congrats to Marina and the Friends of the Immigrant House for reaching this important milestone! The following is a reprint of a press release put out by the Board of Supervisors on March 22, 2016.*

The Santa Clara County Board of Supervisors today (3/22/2016) awarded the Historical Heritage Grant to the City of Mountain View for restoration of the Immigrant House. At the recommendation of the County's Historical Heritage Commission, and on a unanimous vote by the Board of Supervisors, the County approved $50,000 in funding to support the renovation and relocation of the building to its new home in Heritage Park.

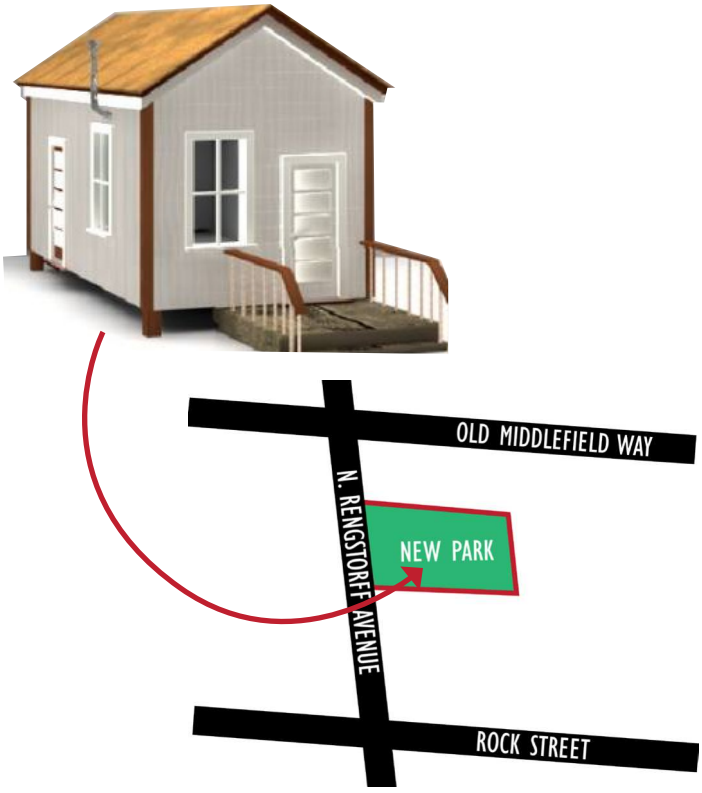
"Our Valley rightfully takes pride in its 21st century role as a technology and thought leader," said County Supervisor Joe Simitian, "but there's a history here we would do well to remember, and learn from. It's just so important that we protect these pieces of our history for future generations."

The County funds represent only a portion of the funding necessary to preserve the Immigrant House, but, said Simitian, "County support closes the funding gap and will bring this worthy project to fruition."

The Immigrant House is one of the oldest buildings in the City of Mountain View, constructed around 1888. The 300-square-foot building will be the centerpiece of Heritage Park, a new public park at 771 N. Rengstorff Ave. in Mountain View.

Between 1990 and 2004, the Board of Supervisors has allocated $500,000 annually to the Park Charter Historical Heritage Fund to promote historic preservation projects and awareness of Santa Clara County's cultural, historical, archaeological, and natural heritage resources. Due to fiscal constraints, the program was not funded in 2005 and 2006, but was reinstated in 2007 at a reduced level of $100,000.

"The Immigrant House is an iconic part of Mountain View's history," said Ryan McCauley, who sits on the Historical Heritage Commission. "It serves as a reminder of our past, and now will be a lasting part of our community's future. This is a great example of the City of Mountain View and Santa Clara County working collaboratively to keep the community's history alive."



WWII Aircraft Return to Moffett Field

Submitted by Eugene Sharp
MVHA Historical Data Chair

Our members I am sure would like to know that the Collings Foundation returns to Moffett Field May 20 through May 28. Vintage World War II-era B-17, B-24 and P-51 airplanes will be there and rides will be available. Four videos of last year's Collings Foundation event at Moffett Field are available to view on my YouTube channel, accessible via this URL:

http://tinyurl.com/esharp-videos

For more information on the Collings Foundation, visit:

www.collingsfoundation.org/event/mountain-view-moffett-federal-airfield/

Editor's Note: *A shout-out to our friends at the Moffett Field Historical Society. Be sure to visit their fantastic museum at Moffett Field if you plan on attending the Collings Foundation event!*

Street Talk



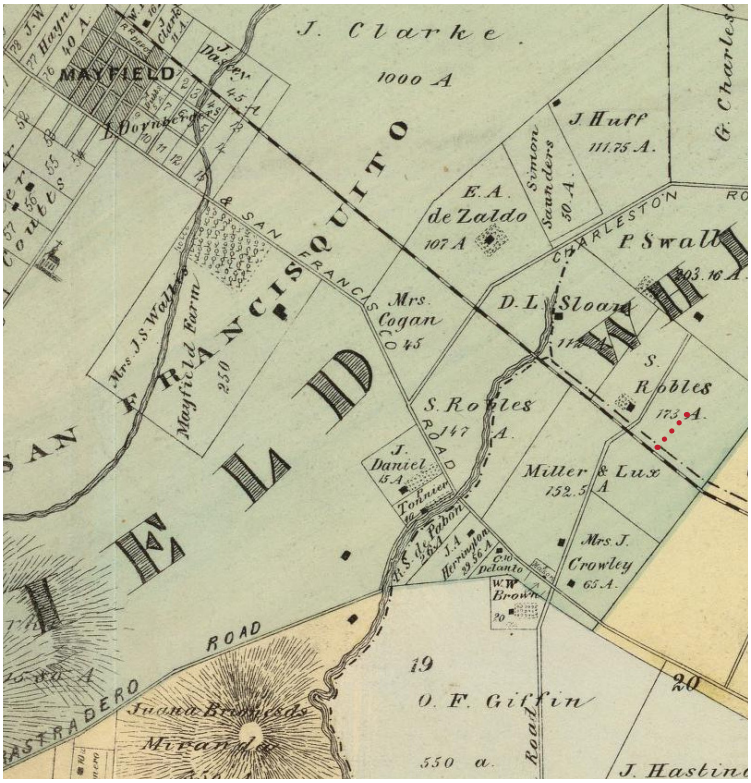
By Nick Perry
Newsletter Editor

In anticipation of our upcoming Spring Event, let's take a look at the history behind the name "Mayfield" and Mountain View's "Mayfield Avenue."

Mayfield is a popular place-name throughout the English-speaking world. You can find a place called Mayfield in at least a dozen states, and in six different countries. It was even the name of the fictitious town where the iconic "Leave it to Beaver" television show took place.

But long before Beaver Cleaver's Mayfield became a part of American pop-culture, the name Mayfield was an important part of our local history. The first recorded use of Mayfield in Santa Clara County can be traced to 1853 when Elisha O. Crosby established the "Mayfield Farm" on 250 acres of Rancho Rincon de San Francisquito that he purchased from the Robles Family. Soon after, the name "Mayfield" was adopted by a stagecoach stop settlement on El Camino Real, just to the north of Mayfield Farm. There's much more to be said about the Town of Mayfield, but we'll save the details for our May 1st event!

Mountain View's Mayfield Avenue is also named after the Mayfield Farm, but in a round-about way. The road is actually named for Mayfield Mall, and once served as its primary vehicular entrance. The mall, in turn, was named after the long-lost Town of Mayfield, which was named after Mayfield Farm. Whew!



This 1876 map shows the Town of Mayfield (upper left) and Mayfield Farm (center left) on El Camino Real (Labeled "San Francisco Road"). The approximate location of Mountain View's present-day Mayfield Avenue is indicated with a red-dotted line. For geographic orientation, the parcel labeled "Mrs. J. Crowley" is today the San Antonio Shopping Center.

But wait, there's more! Before it was known as Mayfield Avenue, the street sported a pretty quirky and short-lived name. Some of you may remember it from a previous edition of this column. But for those who don't, I'll share that bit of trivia (along with some recently discovered photos) at our Spring Event.

Hope to see you there!



Mayfield Avenue as viewed from Central Expressway when Mayfield Mall was still open. The mall's iconic butterfly logo (featured prominently in this newsletter) can be seen on the tower sign that greeted drivers along Central Expressway.

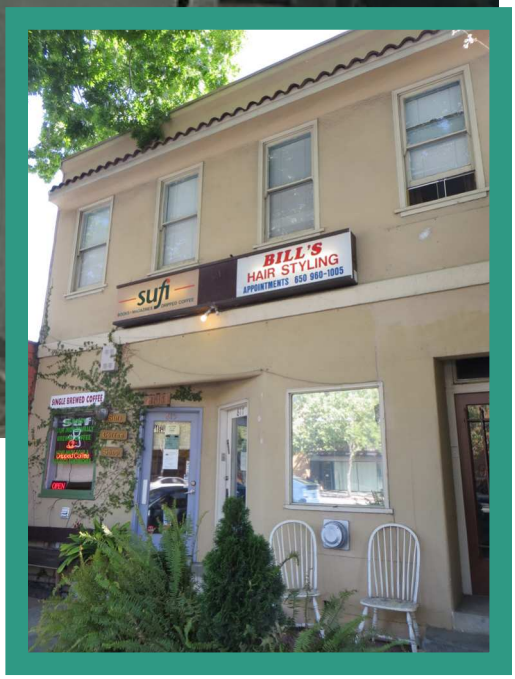
Special Feature



THE CHILI HOUSE MYSTERY

When an early 20th century building was recently demolished, it revealed traces of a business whose origins and history flummox even the most intrepid Mountain View historians....

By Candace Bowers
MVHA President



The hand-painted "A&A Chili & Sandwiches" sign pictured above was recently revealed when the building on the right was demolished.

It might sound like the title of a detective novel, but it's been puzzling local history buffs since January, when a building demolition on El Camino Real revealed a ghost sign from a long-forgotten business.

With the go-ahead given for a mixed-use development at the corner of W. El Camino Real and Castro Street, several buildings were torn down, including the Rug Center, Avis car rental and the narrow, two-story Sufi Coffee Shop. The demolition of the Sufi Coffee building revealed the exterior wall of its neighbor, a gray cottage-like building that has been left standing at 821 W. El Camino. On the side of the building are the painted words "A & A Chili & Sandwiches."

When I first saw this intriguing sign, I immediately pulled over and posted a photo to the MVHA's Facebook page. Then I hurried back to the Mountain View History Center to see what I could find. In a nutshell: I don't have the answer, even after scouring the History Center's archives.

For years, this building was the site of the 101 Club; we are able to trace it to at least 1950. Prior to that, our collection of directories is incomplete, but those we do have, don't have a listing for either the 821 address or any type of chili restaurant. Similarly, we have only street photos and aerial photos that show the 101 Club.

Meanwhile, a Mountain View resident who'd spotted the sign had been doing his own research. He felt that the style of lettering on the sign would place it at the turn of the century, when chili parlors were a popular trend. Yet longtime residents have said that there was no such commercial development on that stretch of El Camino Real until the 1940s. Others have suggested that the sign could have been painted in anticipation of a business that never actually opened.

Coincidentally, there WAS a chili place on El Camino Real (at 1407, currently El Paso Café), but it came along much later. Again, there's not much information on Art's Chili Bowl, outside of personal memories. Could these two chili parlors, which both start with the letter A, be related?

If you have any clues to the Chili House Mystery, please share them with us on our Facebook page; send us an email; or stop by the History Center on Tuesdays between 1:00 and 5:00 p.m. Maybe you can help us solve the Chili House Mystery!

Winter Meeting Recap

MOVING MOUNTAIN VIEW

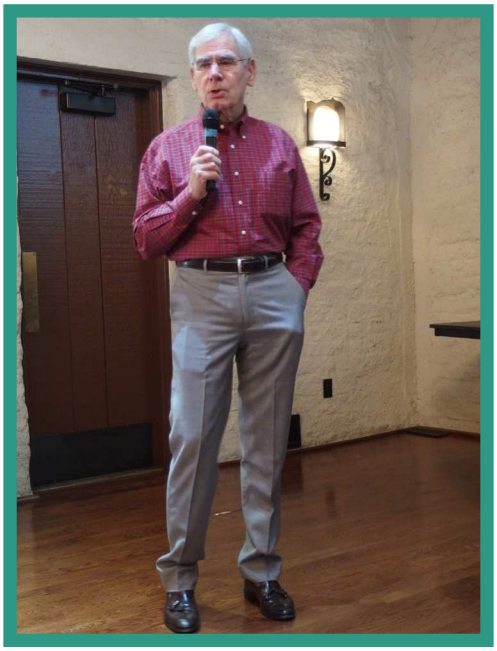
Looking Back at Our Transportation History

At our Winter Meeting on January 31, our members and guests gathered in the historic Adobe Building to learn about local transportation history. The afternoon's cool temperatures allowed us to light up the Adobe's fireplace, creating a warm and cozy environment to mix and mingle over refreshments procured by our Hospitality Chair, Helene Hughes.

The meeting began with brief welcoming remarks from our new MVHA President Candace Bowers. Mountain View Mayor Patricia Showalter then introduced Rod Diridon Sr., our featured guest speaker for the afternoon. Rod presented an informative slide show that traced the rich history of rail transportation in Santa Clara County. After Rod's presentation, Aaron Quigley from the Santa Clara Valley Transportation Authority brought us up to speed on recent and upcoming transportation projects in the area. Very special thanks to MVHA Member Lucas Ramirez, for organizing the afternoon's program!



Mayor Pat Showalter introduces Rod Diridon Sr.



Rod Diridon Sr. discusses the history of transportation in Santa Clara County.



As the Adobe's fireplace flickers behind him, Aaron Quigley from the VTA brings us up-to-date on recent transportation developments.



After our speakers' presentations, members and guests mingled and enjoyed the Adobe's cozy atmosphere.

Membership

Membership Report

Submitted by June Casey
Membership Chair

Membership as of March 5, 2016

Honored Members	2
Life Members	112
Family Members	82
Single Members	116
TOTAL MEMBERSHIP	**311**

New Members: Richard and Sharon Horton.
A warm welcome to our new members!

Volunteer Opportunities

The MVHA welcomes members interested in lending their time and talent. Below are some immediate needs:

Event Tabling: Greet the public at MVHA's table at upcoming events.

History Center: Help us share our historic archives with the public at the library.

Board Positions: We have immediate openings to fill on our Board! Help us plan the future of our organization!

We will gladly answer any questions you may have about membership, joining the Board, or volunteering. E-mail questions to: info@mountainviewhistorical.org or call (650) 903 6890.

Faces of the MVHA

Our organization is nothing without its wonderful members! In this feature, we shine a spotlight on members who shared a bit about themselves at our most recent event.



Lillian "Lil" Farris

Year joined:
"I joined sometime around 2000, during the Art & Wine Festival."

Connection to Mtn. View:
"I moved here in 1956 from San Francisco for the wonderful weather, for the Valley of Heart's Delight."

Favorite thing about the MVHA: "Learning all the history of Mountain View and meeting so many wonderful, friendly people."

Favorite spot in Mtn. View:
"Looking out my front door and seeing those beautiful mountains and trees."

MVHA MEMBERSHIP FORM

The MVHA welcomes new members! By becoming a member, you're making a special investment in our mission to preserve and share Mountain View history with the community, conserve priceless archival materials at the History Center, and hold memorable public events throughout the year.
Please support the MVHA, and join us today!

- ☐ New Membership
- ☐ Membership Renewal
- ☐ Single Membership: *$15/year*
- ☐ Family Membership: *$25/year*
- ☐ Life Membership *$200*
- ☐ *I'm interested in volunteer opportunities*
- ☐ *This membership is being given as a gift*

Member Name(s): _____

Street Address: _____

City: _____

State: _____ Zip Code: _____

Telephone: _____

Email: _____

Please make checks payable to: Mtn. View Historical Association

Mail to: Mtn. View Historical Association, P.O. Box 252, Mountain View, CA 94042

Newsletter Subscription Preference:

☐ *Full-color digital edition (E-mail)* ☐ *Black & White print edition (US Post)*

SPRING/SUMMER

April 23
Saturday, 10:00 a.m.–1:00 p.m.
Downtown Spring Parade
Castro Street–Downtown Mtn.View
MVHA volunteers needed!
E-mail info@mountainviewhistorical.org

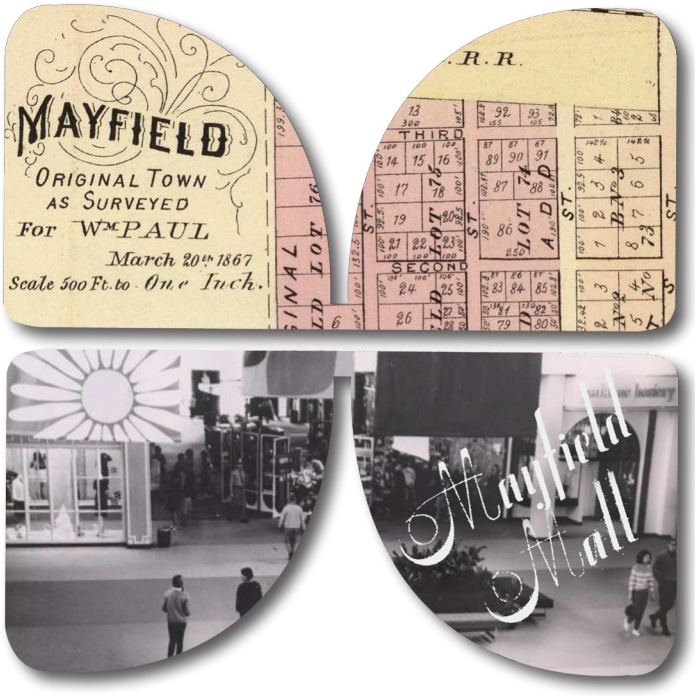
May 1
Sunday, 1:00–3:00 p.m.
MVHA Spring Event/Meeting
Adobe Building–157 Moffett Blvd.
More info. on page 1!

June 8
Wednesday, 6:00–8:00 p.m.
MVHA Board Meeting
M.V. Library History Center, 585 Franklin St.
Interested members encouraged to attend!

August 6
Sunday, 1:00–3:00 p.m.
MVHA Summer Meeting & BBQ!
Adobe Building–157 Moffett Blvd.
Details in our Summer Newsletter!

MVHA SPRING 2016 EVENT

More than a mall: *Mayfield!*



May 1, 2016 - Details on Page 1

EST. 1954

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MOUNTAIN VIEW HISTORICAL ASSOCIATION
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